GLOSSARY

# Glossary

Every musical word in the Handbook, in one line, with the page where it is explained.

**8va (ottava)** play the notes under the dotted line an octave higher p.36

**a tempo** back to the speed before p.82

**accelerando (accel.)** gradually faster p.82

**accent** a > over a note: start it more strongly p.79

**acciaccatura** a tiny note with a slash, crushed in as fast as possible p.88

**accidental** a sharp, flat or natural written before a note; it lasts until the bar line p.39

**Adagio** slow, at ease p.82

**Alberti bass** a broken chord in the left hand: low, high, middle, high (C G E G) p.152

**Allegro** fast and lively p.82

**anacrusis** an upbeat: notes before the first full bar p.65

**Andante** at a walking pace p.82

**appoggiatura** a tiny note without a slash; it leans, taking half the main note's time p.88

**articulation** how notes are joined or separated: slurs, staccato, tenuto, accents p.79

**augmented triad** a triad with 3 + 3 keys between p.113

**bar** a group of beats between two bar lines p.50

**Baroque** music of about 1600–1750: Bach, Handel p.159

**bass clef** the F clef: its two dots hug the line for bass F p.27

**beam** a thick line joining quavers or semiquavers into a beat p.65

**beat** the steady pulse you count p.50

**binary form** two sections, A B p.156

**broken chord** the notes of a chord played one after another p.142

**cadence** the last two chords of a phrase: musical punctuation p.139

**cantabile** in a singing style p.79

**chord** three or more notes played together p.110

**circle of fifths** the keys in a circle: go right, one more sharp; go left, one more flat p.105

**Classical** music of about 1750–1820: Haydn, Mozart p.159

**clef** the sign at the start of the staff that names one line p.27

**coda** an ending section; jump to it at "To Coda" p.71

**compound time** each beat is a dotted note and divides into three (6/8, 9/8, 12/8) p.62

**crescendo (cresc.)** getting louder, little by little p.76

**crotchet** a note worth one beat in 4/4 p.53

**da capo (D.C.)** "from the head": go back to the beginning p.71

**dal segno (D.S.)** "from the sign": go back to the segno p.71

**diminished triad** a triad with 2 + 2 keys between p.113

**diminuendo (dim.)** getting softer, little by little p.76

**dolce** sweetly p.79

**dominant** the 5th note of the scale, and the chord built on it (V) p.116

**dot** adds half the note's value p.56

**duplet** two notes in the time of three p.65

**dynamics** the signs for loud and soft: pp p mp mf f ff p.76

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**enharmonic** two names for one key, such as F♯ and G♭ p.39

**fermata** a pause: hold the note longer than written p.82

**Fine** "the end": after a D.C. or D.S., stop here p.71

**five-finger position** one finger on each of five keys in a row p.163

**flat (♭)** the very next key to the left p.39

**form** the plan of a whole piece, in letters p.156

**forte (f)** loud p.76

**grand staff** treble and bass staves joined by a brace p.27

**hairpin** a crescendo or diminuendo sign that opens or closes p.76

**hemiola** two bars of three felt as three bars of two p.68

**homophonic** a tune with chords underneath p.152

**imitation** another hand or voice copies the idea p.150

**interval** the distance between two notes p.42

**inversion** a chord with a note other than the root at the bottom p.119

**key** the scale a piece is built on, and its home note p.99

**key signature** the sharps or flats at the start of every line p.99

**Largo** very slow and broad p.82

**leading note** the 7th note of the scale, one key below home p.93

**ledger line** a short line for a note above or below the staff p.36

**legato** smoothly joined p.79

**major scale** tone, tone, semitone, tone, tone, tone, semitone p.93

**major triad** a triad with 3 + 2 keys between p.113

**metronome mark** ♩ = 76: 76 beats in a minute p.82

**mezzo (m)** "half": mp half soft, mf half loud p.76

**Middle C** the C nearest the middle of the keyboard, on a ledger line between the staves p.22

**minim** a note worth two crotchets p.53

**minor scale** the major scale on the same note with 3, 6 and 7 one key lower p.96

**minor triad** a triad with 2 + 3 keys between p.113

**Moderato** at a moderate speed p.82

**modulation** changing key during a piece p.154

**monophonic** one line alone p.152

**mordent** the note, its neighbour above (or below), the note p.88

**motif** a short idea of 2 to 6 notes that comes back p.148

**natural (♮)** cancels a sharp or flat p.39

**octave** from one note to the next of the same name: 11 keys between p.45

**ornament** a small sign for a quick group of notes around the main note p.88

**pedal (sustain)** the right pedal: notes keep ringing until you lift it p.85

**perfect cadence** V to I: a full stop p.139

**phrase** a musical sentence, often 4 bars p.148

**pianissimo (pp)** very soft p.76

**piano (p)** soft p.76

**plagal cadence** IV to I: the "Amen" p.139

**polyphonic** two or more tunes at once p.152

**Presto** very fast p.82

**progression** a trip from chord to chord p.144

**pulse** the steady beat underneath the music p.50

**quaver** half a crotchet p.53

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**rallentando (rall.)** gradually slower p.82

**relative minor** the minor key with the same key signature, a minor 3rd below p.96

**repeat sign** two dots and a double bar: play the bars again p.71

**rest** a silence of a set length p.53

**ritardando (rit.)** gradually slower p.82

**Romantic** music of about 1820–1900: Chopin, Schumann p.159

**rondo** A B A C A: the first idea keeps coming back p.156

**root** the note a chord is built on and named after p.110

**rubato** time stretched and given back, for expression p.68

**scale** the notes of a key in order, up or down p.93

**semibreve** a whole note: four crotchets p.53

**semiquaver** half a quaver p.53

**semitone** the very next key: no key between p.22

**sequence** the same shape repeated higher or lower p.150

**seventh chord** a triad with one more 3rd on top p.122

**sforzando (sfz)** one note made suddenly strong p.76

**sharp (♯)** the very next key to the right p.39

**sight-reading** playing music at first sight p.167

**simple time** each beat divides into two (2/4, 3/4, 4/4) p.59

**slash chord** C/E: the chord, then the bass note p.131

**slur** a curve over different notes: join them p.79

**staccato** a dot: short, detached p.79

**staff** the five lines and four spaces music is written on p.27

**subdominant** the 4th note of the scale, and the chord built on it (IV) p.116

**swing** pairs of quavers played long–short p.68

**syncopation** the stress falls off the beat p.68

**tempo** the speed of the beat p.50

**tenuto** a line: hold the note its full length p.79

**ternary form** A B A: out, away and back p.156

**texture** how many lines sound at once, and how they fit p.152

**theme and variations** one tune, changed each time it returns p.156

**tie** a curve joining two notes of the same pitch: one longer sound p.56

**time signature** top: how many beats; bottom: which note gets one beat p.59

**tone** two semitones: one key between p.22

**tonic** the 1st note of the scale: home p.93

**treble clef** the G clef: it curls round the line for treble G p.27

**triad** three notes stacked: play one, skip one, play one p.110

**trill** the note and its neighbour above, back and forth quickly p.88

**triplet** three notes in the time of two p.65

**turn** above, the note, below, the note p.88

**twelve-bar blues** I I I I · IV IV I I · V IV I I p.144

**una corda (u.c.)** the left (soft) pedal p.85

**upbeat** see anacrusis p.65

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